Nicolas Benning

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R&D Manager / Engineering Manager

R&D Manager and Technical Leader with over 10 years of experience in enterprise software engineering, distributed architectures (.NET, AWS Cloud, microservices), and leading multi-team engineering organizations (4 Scrum teams, ~25 developers and team leaders). Passionate about technical modernization, engineering excellence, and product-tech strategic alignment.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

R&D Manager — Amex GBT Neo

2023-11 — Present

Engineering leadership for 4 Scrum teams (~25 developers and team leaders) building Neo Expense, an enterprise SaaS solution for corporate expense management.

- Direct people management and technical leadership across 4 international Scrum teams (25+ engineers and team leads): team structuring, coaching leaders, and strategic alignment with product vision
- Spearheaded legacy backend modernization migrating to a modern, resilient .NET stack
- Led the comprehensive frontend redesign and overhaul to Vue.js
- Initiated and framed the architectural transition from monolith to microservices
- Actively contributed to the infrastructure migration from on-premise datacenters to AWS cloud

Senior Software Engineer — Shift Technology

2022-01 — 2023-11

Fullstack development on AI-driven SaaS platforms for claims automation and insurance fraud detection.

- Fullstack feature engineering using C# / .NET and React.js on highly scalable distributed architectures
- Designed high-performance REST APIs and implemented continuous delivery and high software quality standards (xUnit, systematic code reviews)

Software Engineer — Sinequa

2021-06 — 2021-12

Development and maintenance on the Sinequa Enterprise Search platform (enterprise AI search engine).

- Fullstack developer (C#, .NET 5, TypeScript) within the 'Platform' core team handling cross-functional systems
- Built external APIs, enhanced administration interfaces, and log visualization systems

Software Engineer — KDS (American Express Global Business Travel group)

2015-08 — 2021-05

Fullstack development on enterprise SaaS expense management application (Neo Expense).

- Fullstack developer (C#, ASP.NET Core, Backbone.js) within an international Scrum team (France, Romania)
- Technical lead and high-level software design point-of-contact in close collaboration with Product Management
- Application maintenance and bug backlog management with Customer Support, Product, and QA teams
- Lead maintainer for third-party frontend and backend dependencies (security upgrades, vulnerability audits)
- Production platform monitoring and observability using the ELK stack (Elasticsearch, Logstash, Kibana)

Software Engineering Intern — KDS

2015-02 — 2015-08

Final-year engineering internship.

- Documentation and enhancement of an ASP.NET WebAPI application with Swagger
- Implementation of application monitoring with the ELK stack

Software Developer Intern — Bouygues Travaux Publics

2014-06 — 2014-07

Engineering development internship.

- Developed an Excel/PDF converter tool and enhanced document storage web applications (VB.NET, ASP.NET, SQL Server)

EDUCATION

Master of Science in Engineering (Diplôme d'ingénieur) — Télécom SudParis 2012 — 2015

Computer Science & Telecommunications
Major: Distributed Systems & Software Services Architecture

Erasmus Exchange - MSc in Computing — Dublin Institute of Technology (DIT) 2014-09 — 2015-01

Advanced Software Development

Classes Préparatoires aux Grandes Écoles (CPGE) — Lycée Saint-Louis, Paris 2009 — 2012

MPSI & MP (Mathematics, Physics, Computer Science)

French Baccalauréat — Lycée Frédéric Mistral, Fresnes 2009

Science major, Mathematics track
With Highest Honors (Mention Très Bien)

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Management & Leadership: Engineering Management • Technical Leadership • Multi-team Management (25+ people) • Agile & Scrum at Scale • Leader Mentoring & Coaching • Product-Tech Strategic Alignment

Backend & Architecture: C# • .NET 8 / .NET Core • ASP.NET Core • Microservices Architecture • High-performance REST APIs • Cloud Migration & Modernization • SQL Server • PostgreSQL • LINQ

Frontend & Web: Vue.js • React.js • TypeScript • JavaScript (ES6+) • Modern Frontend Redesign • HTML5 / CSS3 • Node.js

Cloud, DevOps & Observability: AWS (Amazon Web Services) • Docker • CI/CD • ELK Stack (Elasticsearch, Kibana) • Git (GitHub, GitLab) • Swagger • TeamCity

LANGUAGES & INTERESTS

Languages:
- French: Native speaker
- English: Full professional proficiency (C2)
- German: Elementary proficiency

Interests:
- Mixology (Cocktail crafting, Flavor design)
- Scuba Diving (CMAS 2-Star / FFESSM Level 2)
- Travel & Live Arts (Concerts, Theater, Cultural exploration)